BC GAME MASTERS

Championship Official Tournament

RULEBOOK

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SECTION 1 - EVENT OVERVIEW & EVENT INFORMATION

Event Overview

The BC Game Masters Championship is a standalone Counter-Strike 2 LAN tournament organized by VANTA.GL (FZ-C.L.L VANTAGL, License No: 2643721.01, Address: Meydan Grandstand, 6th Floor, Meydan Road, Nad Al Sheba, Dubai, U.A.E.), operating as an independent competitive esports event.

BC Game Masters Championship is a Valve Regional Standings (VRS)-eligible Tier 2 tournament, structured to comply with Valve's tournament operation guidelines for ranked events. Match results from the event contribute toward Valve's official VRS rankings, which are used to evaluate team performance and eligibility for future CS2 competitions.

The event is designed as an open-registration LAN tournament, welcoming professional and semi-professional teams from the Global region. While registration is open to all eligible teams, competitive seeding is determined using Valve's official VRS rankings to ensure a balanced and fair tournament structure.

This rulebook defines all rules, formats, administrative procedures, and conduct requirements applicable to teams participating in the BC Game Masters Championship. All teams, players, and staff are expected to read and comply fully with the contents of this document.

Event Information

- Event Name: BC Game Masters Championship
- Event Type: Standalone LAN Tournament

- Game Title: Counter-Strike 2
- Time Zone: All times listed in this rulebook follow Bucharest local time (EET/EEST, GMT+2)
- Sanctioning & Ranking:
    - Valve Regional Standings (VRS) eligible
    - Tier 2 compliant event
    - Results contribute to Valve VRS rankings
- Dates: 24-26 March 2026
- Location: Nexus Gamers Pub, Bucharest, Romania
- Event Format: Full on-site LAN event

Team Participation & Capacity

- Maximum Teams: 24 teams
- Team Size:
    - 5 players (mandatory)
    - 1 coach (optional)
- Attendance Requirement:
  All players and registered coaches must be able to attend the event on-site for the full duration of the tournament.

- Coaches:
  Coaches are permitted to attend and participate under Valve's coaching rules, with communication restrictions applied during live rounds, as detailed later in this rulebook.

Competitive Structure Overview

- Open registration, no direct invitations
- Open to teams from the Global region
- Seeding based on Valve VRS rankings (March ranking snapshot)
- Top 8 VRS-ranked registered teams seeded directly into the Main Event
- Remaining teams compete in GSL-style group stages to qualify for playoffs
- Playoffs conducted in Best-of-3 format

(Detailed format is defined in the Tournament Format section.)

SECTION 2 - REGISTRATION, ELIGIBILITY & ROSTERS

Registration

Teams must register for the BC Game Masters Championship via the official event website:
https://bgm.vanta.gl/

Registration is open to all eligible teams on a first-come, first-served basis, subject to the maximum team cap defined in this rulebook.

- Registration Opens: February 10, 2026 at 19:00 (GMT+2)

- Registration Closes: Fourteen (14) days before the event begins, at 23:59 (Bucharest time)

A team's participation is only considered confirmed once the registration fee has been successfully paid and all required registration information has been submitted through the official platform..

Registration Fee

- Registration Fee: $2,000 per team
- The fee covers participation for five (5) players and one (1) optional coach.
- Registration fees are non-transferable between teams.

Failure to complete payment before the registration deadline will result in the team not being included in the tournament.

Team & Player Eligibility

Team Eligibility

- Participation in the tournament is open to all teams globally. There are no prerequisites for registration, such as prior qualification, invitation, or a minimum ranking..

Player Eligibility

All players must own and compete using their own personal Steam / Counter-Strike 2 account. Accounts must be in good standing and not have any VAC bans or active competitive bans.

Players with VAC bans or other integrity-related bans are strictly prohibited from participating, regardless of ban age or account status.

Age Requirement

All participating players must be a minimum of 16 years old when the tournament begins.

Team registration confirms that every player satisfies this age restriction.

Roster Rules

Roster Size:

- Each team may register:
    - 5 players (mandatory)
    - 1 coach (optional)

Roster Lock

- Rosters are locked fourteen (14) days before the start of the event, in line with the registration closing deadline.

Core Rule

- After the roster lock, teams must retain their registered core of at least three (3) out of the five (5) original players.
- Changes that violate the core requirement are not permitted and may result in disqualification.

Emergency Player Replacement

- In case of an emergency during the LAN event (such as illness or injury preventing a player from continuing), teams may request to use a pre-registered stand-in.
- Teams may register one (1) stand-in player in advance during the registration process. The stand-in must meet all player eligibility requirements outlined in this rulebook.
- The use of a stand-in requires approval from tournament administrators.
- If a team cannot field five eligible players and has no approved stand-in available, the team may be required to forfeit their remaining matches or be disqualified from the tournament.

Check-in Requirements

All teams must check in on-site at the venue of the event by the designated time communicated by the organizers.

Failure to check in on time may result in disqualification or match forfeiture at the discretion of the tournament administrators.

SECTION 3 - PRIZE POOL & PRIZE DISTRIBUTION

Prize Pool Overview

The BC Game Masters Championship features a total prize pool of $50,000 USDT (ERC-20 on the Ethereum network) Crypto.

The total amount and distribution are fixed regardless of the final number of participating teams, provided the event takes place as scheduled.

Prize Distribution

The prize pool will be distributed among the top eight (8) teams as follows:

- 1st Place: $30,000 USDT
- 2nd Place: $10,000 USDT
- 3rd Place: $5,000 USDT
- 4th Place: $2,000 USDT
- 5th–8th Place: $750 USDT each

All prize amounts are listed in USDT.

Payment Details

Prize payments will be made via crypto transfer (ERC-20 on the Ethereum network). Payments will be issued within ninety (90) days after the conclusion of the event, unless delays occur due to regulatory, compliance, or verification requirements. The full prize amount for each placement will be paid in one single transfer to the designated recipient. The designated recipient must be either: the team organization, or the team captain or authorized representative. It is the team's responsibility to: Provide correct and complete payment details and Agree internally on prize splits between players and coaches.

The organizer's obligation is considered fulfilled once the prize has been transferred to the designated recipient.

Taxes & Legal Compliance

Prize money will be awarded and disbursed in accordance with international laws.

- Any tax obligations arising from prize winnings are the sole responsibility of the recipients.

- The organizer may require invoices, identification documents, or payment forms before processing payouts.

Failure to provide required documentation may delay payment.

Disqualification & Forfeiture of Prizes

If a team is disqualified at any stage of the tournament, including during playoffs or after match completion, the organizer reserves the right to forfeit the team's claim to any prize money, regardless of their final placement.

Disqualification due to cheating, match-fixing, roster violations, or severe rule breaches will automatically void prize eligibility.

SECTION 4 - TOURNAMENT FORMAT

Overview of Tournament Stages

The BC Game Masters Championship is played over multiple days and consists of two primary competitive phases:

1. Group Stage

2. Playoffs (Main Event)

With a maximum of 24 registered teams, the tournament format is structured to combine open competition with VRS-based seeding while maintaining a clear and efficient progression path.

Stage 1 - Group Stage

Participants

- 16 teams participate in the Group Stage.

- These are all registered teams excluding the top eight (8) teams by Valve Regional Standings (VRS), which are seeded directly into the Playoffs.

Group Formation

- Teams are divided into four (4) GSL-style groups, each consisting of four (4) teams.

- Groups are formed using a seeded draw system, based on competitive strength.

Seeding Pots

Teams are allocated into four pots by the organizer, using the following criteria:

- Valve VRS ranking
- HLTV ranking (where applicable)
- Recent competitive results and performance

Each group contains exactly one team from each pot.

Group Format (GSL)

Each group follows a GSL (double-elimination within group) format:

- Opening Matches: Best-of-1
- Winners' Match: Best-of-1
- Elimination Match: Best-of-3
- Decider Match: Best-of-3

All matches use overtime to ensure a decisive result. Draws are not permitted.

Advancement from Groups

- The Group Winner and Group Runner-up advance to the Playoffs.

- A total of eight (8) teams qualify from the Group Stage.

Teams finishing third or fourth in their groups are eliminated from the tournament.

Group Stage Scheduling & Readiness

- Group Stage matches are played across available LAN setups in scheduled waves.
- Teams must be ready on the server at least 15 minutes before their scheduled match time.
- Short breaks (approximately 5–10 minutes) may be provided between consecutive matches.
- Teams playing Decider Matches must be prepared for limited downtime between matches.

Stage 2 - Playoffs (Main Event)

Participants

The Playoffs consist of sixteen (16) teams:

- 8 teams qualified from the Group Stage
- 8 teams seeded directly based on Valve VRS rankings (March snapshot)

Seeding into Playoffs

- The top eight (8) registered teams according to the March Valve VRS rankings are directly seeded into the Playoffs.

- The 8 VRS-seeded teams and the 8 Group Stage qualifier teams are paired in the Opening Playoff Round (BO1) as follows:

Match #	VRS-Seeded Team	Group Stage Position
Match 1	VRS #1	4th Ranked Group Stage Runner-up
Match 2	VRS #8	1st Ranked Group Stage Winner
Match 3	VRS #4	1st Ranked Group Stage Runner-up
Match 4	VRS #5	4th Ranked Group Stage Winner
Match 5	VRS #6	3rd Ranked Group Stage Winner
Match 6	VRS #3	2nd Ranked Group Stage Runner-up
Match 7	VRS #7	2nd Ranked Group Stage Winner

Match 8	VRS #2	3rd Ranked Group Stage Runner-up

Playoff Seeding Clarification

The top eight (8) teams according to the official Valve Regional Standings (VRS) February ranking will be seeded directly into the Playoffs as Seeds 1–8.

Seeds 9–12 will be the teams that finish first in their respective Group Stage groups. Seeds 13–16 will be the teams that finish second in their groups.

The internal order of Seeds 9–16 will be determined using the same criteria applied during the initial tournament seeding:

1. Valve Regional Standings (VRS) ranking
2. HLTV ranking
3. Average FACEIT ELO (if no VRS ranking is available)

This seeding order will determine playoff matchups and veto priority.

Playoff Bracket Format

- Single-Elimination Bracket
- Teams are eliminated after one match loss.
- There is no lower bracket.

Match Format

- All Playoff matches are played as Best-of-3 (Bo3) series.
- This includes:
    - Round of 16
    - Quarterfinals
    - Semifinals
    - Grand Final

Grand Final

- The Grand Final is played as a Best-of-3 (Bo3) series.
- There is:
    - No bracket reset
    - No map advantage
- The higher-seeded team is determined by tournament seeding but does not receive competitive advantages beyond standard veto priority.
- The winner of the Grand Final is crowned BC Game Masters Championship Champion.

General Match Rules

- Overtime is enabled for all matches.

- Best-of-1 and Best-of-3 matches follow the same overtime rules as defined in the Match Settings section.
- Half-time breaks are three (3) minutes.
- Forfeits and no-shows are handled under the Conduct & Administration sections of this rulebook.

SECTION 5 - MATCH SCHEDULING & PUNCTUALITY

Match Schedule

A detailed match schedule, including approximate start times for each round, will be provided to all teams prior to the event and made available through official tournament communication channels.

All teams are expected to follow the published schedule closely. Matches are intended to begin at their scheduled start times. Any deviation from the schedule must be approved by tournament administrators.

Pre-Match Readiness

Teams must be fully ready at least fifteen (15) minutes before their scheduled match start time.

Being “ready” means:

- All five (5) players are present at the venue
- All players are logged into the match server or designated staging area
- Equipment is set up and functional
- Players are prepared to begin the match immediately upon admin instruction

Failure to meet readiness requirements may result in penalties.

Late Arrival & Grace Period

If a team is not fully ready at the scheduled match start time:

- A grace period of up to ten (10) minutes may be granted at the discretion of tournament administrators.
- After the grace period expires, the administrators may:
    - Award a map forfeit, or
    - Declare a match forfeit, depending on the situation and tournament phase.

A complete no-show (failure to appear) will result in an automatic match loss by forfeit.

Breaks & Downtime

To maintain tournament flow and scheduling integrity:

- Teams are allowed up to ten (10) minutes between maps in a Best-of-3 series.
- Teams are allowed up to thirty (30) minutes between consecutive matches.
- If a preceding match runs longer than expected, subsequent breaks may be shortened at admin discretion.

Teams with back-to-back matches must remain available in the tournament area unless explicitly granted permission by an admin to leave.

Schedule Adjustments

Tournament administrators reserve the right to adjust match start times, reorder matches, and shorten or extend breaks.

These adjustments may be made to accommodate delays, technical issues, broadcast requirements, or venue constraints. Teams are expected to remain flexible and cooperative to ensure the smooth operation of the event.

Failure to comply with scheduling instructions may result in penalties.

SECTION 6 - GAME RULES & MATCH SETTINGS

General Game Settings

All matches in the BC Game Masters Championship are played using Counter-Strike 2 on the latest available version on Steam at the time of the event.

- Game Title: Counter-Strike 2
- Platform: LAN servers provided by the tournament organizer
- Server Type: Offline LAN environment
- Anti-Cheat:
    - No third-party anti-cheat client is required
    - Tournament administrators will actively monitor all matches for suspicious behavior

All matches will be played using the official CS2 competitive configuration. Server settings will remain unchanged for the duration of the tournament, regardless of any updates released during the event.

Player Accounts

- Players must compete using their own personal Steam / CS2 accounts.
- Account sharing is strictly prohibited.
- All accounts must:
    - Own Counter-Strike 2
    - Be in good standing
    - Have no VAC bans or active competitive bans

Violation of account rules may result in immediate disqualification.

Match Parameters

- Match Format: MR12
- Winning Condition: First team to reach 13 rounds wins the map
- Maximum Regulation Rounds: 24 (12 per half)

Standard Match Settings

- Round Time: 1 minute 55 seconds
- Bomb Timer: 40 seconds

- Freeze Time: 20 seconds
- Buy Time: 20 seconds
- Starting Money (Pistol Round): $800

Overtime Rules

If a map ends 12–12 after regulation:

- Overtime will be played to determine a winner
- Overtime Format: MR3
- Start Money: $10,000
- Teams play:
    - 3 rounds per side
    - Swap sides after 3 rounds

If the score remains tied after one overtime, additional overtime periods will be played under the same rules until a winner is determined.

Side & Map Selection

First Map of a Match

The higher-seeded team may choose one of the following:

- a) Map veto order

- b) Starting side

Subsequent Maps in a Best-of-3

- When a team picks a map, the opposing team selects the starting side.
- Side selection follows the veto process.

Overtime Side Rules

- Teams begin overtime on the side they finished regulation.
- Sides switch after three overtime rounds.
- Overtime repeats until a winner is decided.

Map Pool

The tournament uses the official Active Duty map pool at the time of the event.

Current map pool consists of the following seven (7) maps:

- Inferno
- Mirage
- Nuke
- Ancient
- Overpass

- Dust2
- Anubis

If Valve updates the Active Duty pool prior to the event, the updated pool will be used.

Seeding Determination

All participating teams are seeded prior to the tournament by the organizer.

Seeding is determined using:

- Valve Regional Standings (VRS)
- HLTV rankings (where applicable)
- Recent competitive performance and results

Teams are allocated into seeding pots, with higher-ranked teams receiving higher priority.

In all matches, the higher-seeded team receives veto priority and side selection rights as defined in this rulebook.

Map Veto Process

The veto process is supervised by tournament administrators and may be conducted:

- On-stage
- Through the game server

- Via an approved veto tool

Teams must make their veto decisions promptly. A time limit of approximately 1–2 minutes per decision may be enforced.

Best-of-1 (Bo1) Veto Process

1. Higher-seeded team chooses to be Team A or Team B
2. Team A removes 2 maps
3. Team B removes 3 maps
4. Team A removes 1 map
5. Remaining map is played
6. Team B chooses starting side

Best-of-3 (Bo3) Veto Process

1. Higher-seeded team chooses to be Team A or Team B
2. Team A removes 1 map
3. Team B removes 1 map
4. Team A picks Map 1
5. Team B chooses starting side on Map 1
6. Team B picks Map 2

7. Team A chooses starting side on Map 2
8. Team B removes 1 map
9. Team A removes 1 map
10. Remaining map becomes the decider (Map 3)
11. Team B chooses starting side on Map 3

Match Server & Configuration

- Matches are hosted on tournament-provided LAN servers.
- Teams are given a short setup window before matches to:
    - Execute configs
    - Adjust settings
    - Test peripherals

Once both teams signal readiness, the match goes live. Any configuration issues not raised before the first round begins are considered accepted.

SECTION 7 - PAUSES, INTERRUPTIONS & MATCH RECOVERY

Tactical Pauses (Timeouts)

- Each team is allowed three (3) tactical timeouts per map.

- An additional one (1) tactical timeout is granted per team in overtime.
- Each tactical timeout lasts 30 seconds.
- Tactical timeouts may be used consecutively if desired.

Tactical timeouts are intended solely for team discussion and strategic adjustments. Teams must use the in-game timeout functionality to initiate them.

Once a team has exhausted its allotted tactical timeouts for a map, no further tactical pauses are permitted for that map.

Technical Pauses

If a player encounters a legitimate technical issue (hardware malfunction, disconnect, severe lag):

- The affected player must immediately notify the server by typing "!tech" in chat.
- The game should be paused as soon as possible.

During a technical pause:

- Players, coaches, and team staff must remain at their stations.
- No game-related communication is permitted.
- Coaches are not allowed to speak.

Abuse of technical pauses may result in penalties.

Admin Pauses

Tournament administrators may pause a match at any time to:

- Resolve technical issues
- Address disputes
- Handle server or venue-related problems
- Prevent competitive integrity issues

During an admin pause:

- All participants must follow admin instructions
- No game-related communication is allowed
- Coaches must remain silent

Duration of Pauses

- Tactical timeouts are fixed at 30 seconds unless chained.
- Technical pauses last only as long as required to resolve the issue.
- If a technical issue cannot be resolved within a reasonable time frame (generally up to 10 minutes), administrators may:
    - Force the match to continue, or
    - Declare a forfeit if a team is unable to continue playing

Teams are expected to have backup equipment available to minimize delays.

Match Interruptions & Recovery

The BC Game Masters Championship aims to ensure match integrity in the event of interruptions.

Server Crash or Full Disconnect

If the game server crashes or all players disconnect simultaneously:

- The round in progress is voided and replayed
- The match will be restored to the last fully completed round
- CS2 match recovery tools (“match medic”) will be used where available.

External communication, including phone usage or stream viewing, is strictly prohibited during recovery.

Player Disconnects

- If a player disconnects early in a round before any significant action, admins may order a round restart.
- Significant action includes:
    - Damage dealt
    - Kills
    - Utility usage
    - Revealing strategic information

If significant action has occurred, the round continues with remaining players.

Admins reserve the right to replay a round if multiple disconnects or severe issues materially impact the outcome.

No Replay for Team Errors

Rounds will not be replayed for:

- Misbuys
- Configuration mistakes
- Accidental disconnects caused by player error

Such situations are considered part of normal competitive risk.

Match Medic Usage

Tournament administrators may use CS2's match restoration tools to:

- Restore scorelines
- Restore economy states where possible

If full restoration is not feasible, admins may restore the score only and resume play under standard conditions.

A full map restart will only occur in extreme cases where competitive integrity cannot otherwise be preserved.

Map Bugs & Exploits

The intentional use of bugs, glitches, or exploits is strictly prohibited, including but not limited to:

- Clipping through map geometry
- Pixel walking on unintended surfaces
- Abusive boosts that allow unintended sightlines
- Scripted movement exploits

When in doubt, teams must ask administrators for clarification. Exploits that clearly violate fair play principles will be penalized even if not explicitly listed.

SECTION 8 - PLAYER EQUIPMENT, SETUP & VENUE RULES

Provided Equipment

The BC Game Masters Championship is played exclusively on tournament-provided LAN setups. All official matches will use identical hardware configurations to ensure competitive fairness.

Each player station is equipped with the following specifications:

PC Hardware

- CPU: AMD Ryzen 9 9800X3D
- GPU: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5070 Ti
- RAM: 32 GB DDR5 @ 5600 MHz

Peripherals & Furniture

- Monitor: BenQ ZOWIE 400 Hz gaming monitor

- Headset: AceZone tournament headset
- Desk: Electric adjustable desk
- Chair: Ergonomic gaming chair provided by the venue

All systems will have:

- Counter-Strike 2 pre-installed
- Necessary drivers and system software installed
- Identical system configurations across all stations

Hardware configurations will not be altered during the event unless required for technical or safety reasons.

Player-Provided Equipment

Players are required to bring their own personal peripherals, including:

- Mouse
- Keyboard
- Mousepad
- In-ear earphones

Players are responsible for the legality, condition, and functionality of their own equipment. Any peripheral or software that provides an unfair competitive advantage is prohibited.

Setup Time

At the start of each match, or when moving to a new station, teams will be granted a limited setup window (typically 5–10 minutes) to:

- Connect personal peripherals
- Adjust Windows and CS2 settings
- Execute configs and binds
- Verify audio and video settings

Voice Communication

- A local TeamSpeak server hosted on the tournament network will be provided.
- All in-match communication must take place through:
    - The provided local voice server, or
    - The in-game CS2 voice system

The use of external voice or communication software during matches is strictly prohibited.

Coaches

- Coaches are permitted to attend matches in a designated coach area.
- Coaches may join the team's voice channel where applicable.

Valve coaching restrictions apply:

- Coaches may communicate only during:
    - Tactical timeouts
    - Half-time breaks
- Coaches must remain silent during live rounds.

Violations may result in penalties, including warnings, round penalties, or disqualification.

Recording & Communication Devices

During active matches, players are not permitted to possess:

- Mobile phones
- Smart watches
- Tablets
- Recording devices
- Any unauthorized electronic equipment

Such devices must be stored away from the competition area or surrendered to team staff.

Only tournament-approved communication systems may be used.

Attire & Venue Conduct

- There is no mandatory uniform requirement.
- Offensive, obscene, or inappropriate clothing is prohibited.
- Players must respect venue property and comply with staff instructions.

Any damage caused to equipment or venue property may result in financial liability and disciplinary action.

Alcohol & Prohibited Substances

- Players may not consume alcohol while competing.
- Any player appearing intoxicated may be removed from the match or event.
- Illegal drug use is strictly prohibited on the premises.

Violations may result in immediate disqualification.

SECTION 9 - CONDUCT, FAIR PLAY & COMPETITION INTEGRITY

Fair Play & Sportsmanship

All participants in the BC Game Masters Championship are expected to compete with integrity, professionalism, and respect toward opponents, officials, staff, and spectators.

Unsportsmanlike behavior, abuse, or actions that undermine the competitive environment will not be tolerated.

Cheating

Any form of cheating is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate disqualification.

Cheating includes, but is not limited to:

- Use of external software or hacks (aimbots, wallhacks, radar hacks, trigger bots, no-flash, etc.)
- Unauthorized game modifications
- Hardware-based cheating or macros
- Exploiting software vulnerabilities for unfair advantage

Tournament administrators will actively monitor matches. VAC-enabled servers and admin observation are used to detect violations.

Players found cheating may be:

- Disqualified from the event
- Banned from future events organized by the organizer
- Reported to Valve, which may result in further competitive sanctions

Entire teams may be disqualified depending on the severity of the violation.

Ghosting & Outside Assistance

Because the tournament is played on LAN, ghosting is strictly forbidden.

- Players may not receive any outside information during a live match.

- Spectators, eliminated players, or staff may not communicate match information to active players.
- Coaches may only communicate within the limits defined by Valve rules.

Any attempt to relay live match information will result in penalties for both the individual and the team involved.

Exploits & Bug Abuse

Deliberate abuse of game bugs, glitches, or unintended mechanics is prohibited.

This includes:

- Clipping through map geometry
- Pixel walking or standing on unintended surfaces
- Boosts that allow unintended sightlines
- Exploiting newly discovered bugs for advantage

If a bug's legality is unclear, teams must ask administrators before using it. Using an exploit deemed illegal may result in:

- Round forfeits
- Map forfeits
- Match forfeits
- Disqualification, depending on severity

Forbidden Scripts & Configurations

Players may only use configurations and scripts allowed in standard competitive CS2 play.

Allowed:

- Jump-throw binds
- Buy binds
- Standard aliases

Forbidden:

- Recoil scripts
- Rapid-fire macros
- Movement automation
- Any script or macro providing mechanical advantage

Forbidden scripts are illegal even if not actively used. Software-based macros via peripheral drivers are also prohibited.

In-Game Communication & Behavior

- All-chat should be used sparingly and respectfully.
- Harassment, excessive profanity, hate speech, or discriminatory language is prohibited.

- Spamming, taunting, or disruptive behavior may result in penalties.

Players are expected to behave professionally at all times, including during wins and losses.

Player Conduct

Unsportsmanlike conduct includes, but is not limited to:

- Harassment or bullying
- Verbal or physical aggression
- Throwing equipment
- Disrespecting staff or officials

Severe incidents may result in immediate disqualification and removal from the venue.

Compliance with Officials

Tournament administrators and referees have full authority during the event.

- Teams must follow all admin instructions promptly.
- Excessive arguing, refusal to comply, or attempts to mislead officials are considered misconduct.

If a team wishes to dispute a ruling, the team captain must raise the issue calmly with an administrator at an appropriate time.

Rule Enforcement & Penalties

Administrators have final authority over:

- Rule interpretation
- Match results
- Disputes and penalties

Possible penalties include:

- Warnings
- Round loss
- Map loss
- Match forfeiture
- Disqualification
- Event bans

Penalties will be proportional to the offense.

Protests

- Protests must be raised immediately when an issue occurs.
- Issues should not be raised after a match if they were evident during play.
- Admin decisions after review are final.

Judgment calls are not grounds for prolonged dispute.

Match Integrity & Match-Fixing

Any attempt to:

- Fix matches
- Collude with other teams
- Intentionally lose
- Manipulate results

is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate disqualification and potential reporting to Valve.

Definition of Collusion

Collusion refers to any agreement or coordinated conduct between two or more teams, players, or associated parties intended to manipulate match results, influence tournament standings, gain competitive advantage, or alter prize distribution.

Collusion may be established through direct or indirect evidence and does not require that the intended outcome was successfully achieved.

Betting

Players, coaches, and team staff are not allowed to bet on any match in the tournament.

Any involvement in betting-related misconduct will result in removal from the event.

SECTION 10 - MEDIA, STREAMING & PUBLICITY

Official Broadcast

The BC Game Masters Championship may be broadcast live on official streaming platforms selected by the organizer.

- Tournament organizers reserve exclusive rights to stream all matches.
- Players and teams are not permitted to stream their own POVs or matches during the event unless explicitly authorized in writing by the organizer.

Participants may be required to:

- Appear on broadcast
- Participate in interviews
- Take part in promotional content

Refusal without valid reason may be considered unsportsmanlike conduct.

Stream Delay & Competitive Integrity

To protect competitive integrity, all official broadcasts of the BC Game Masters Championship will operate with a stream delay determined by the organizer, with a minimum delay of two (2) minutes.

During active matches, players, coaches, and team staff are strictly prohibited from accessing the official broadcast, restreams, spectator feeds, or any live match coverage.

Access to observer or production feeds is restricted to authorized tournament staff and broadcast personnel only.

Any attempt to access match broadcasts or spectator feeds during live play may be treated as a serious integrity violation and may result in penalties including round loss, map forfeiture, match disqualification, or prize forfeiture.

Gambling & Competing Sponsor Restrictions

- To protect the commercial rights of the tournament and its partners, teams, players, coaches, and team staff may not display or promote branding associated with competing online casinos, betting platforms, or gambling operators during the event.

- This applies to jerseys, apparel, equipment, and any items visible on broadcast, on stage, or during official media appearances.

- The organizer reserves the right to determine whether a sponsor is considered a competing operator. Violations may result in required removal of branding and potential penalties, including delays, forfeits, or disqualification.

Photography & Video Recording

By participating in the event, all players, coaches, and team staff grant permission to the organizer and its partners to:

- Photograph

- Record video and audio

- Use likeness, name, and team branding

Such content may be used for:

- Live broadcasts

- Event recaps

- Marketing and promotional materials
- Social media and digital platforms

No additional compensation is owed for such usage.

SECTION 11 - HEALTH, SAFETY & VENUE RESPONSIBILITY

Health & Safety

The event takes place in a public LAN venue. Participants are expected to:

- Follow all venue safety regulations
- Respect emergency procedures and exits
- Take reasonable care of personal belongings

The organizer is not responsible for:

- Lost or stolen items
- Personal injury caused by negligence or misconduct

Venue Property

Damage caused to:

- Venue property
- Tournament equipment

- Furniture or infrastructure

may result in financial liability for the responsible team or individual.

Alcohol & Substances

- Alcohol consumption is prohibited while competing.
- Players appearing intoxicated may be removed from the event.
- Illegal drugs are strictly forbidden on the premises.

Violations may result in immediate disqualification.

SECTION 12 - REFUNDS, CANCELLATIONS & FORCE MAJEURE

Team Withdrawals & Refunds

- Teams that withdraw from the event may submit a written refund request, subject to the conditions below.
- Withdrawals before 3rd March
  If a team withdraws before 3rd March and the vacated spot can be successfully filled by another team, the withdrawing team will be eligible for a refund of 50% of the registration fee.
- Withdrawals on or after 3rd March

  Any withdrawal request made on or after 3rd March is not eligible for a refund, regardless of reason.

No refunds will be issued for:

- No-shows
- Late withdrawals
- Disqualification due to rule violations

Event Cancellation or Postponement

In the unlikely event that the BC Game Masters Championship is postponed or cancelled due to circumstances beyond the organizer's control, including but not limited to:

- Natural disasters
- Venue failure
- National emergencies
- Health crises

The organizer will offer:

- A full refund, or
- Transfer of registration to a rescheduled event date (if applicable)

Travel & Accommodation

All travel and accommodation arrangements are the sole responsibility of the teams.

The organizer will not:

- Arrange travel
- Provide lodging
- Reimburse transportation or accommodation expenses

Teams are advised to use flexible booking options where possible.

Force Majeure

- The Organizer shall not be liable for any delay, disruption, modification, or cancellation of the event caused by circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to natural disasters, war, civil unrest, government restrictions, public health emergencies, power or internet outages, venue unavailability, or other major operational disruptions.
- In the event of a Force Majeure situation, the Organizer reserves the right to suspend, reschedule, relocate, modify the tournament format, adjust the prize pool if commercially necessary, or cancel the event.
- If the event is cancelled due to Force Majeure, the Organizer may, at its discretion, refund registration fees in full or in part, credit them toward a future event, or retain them to cover non-recoverable operational costs.
- The Organizer shall not be responsible for any travel, accommodation, visa, or other expenses incurred by participating teams.

SECTION 13 - SPIRIT OF THE RULES & AMENDMENTS

This rulebook exists to ensure a fair, competitive, and professional event. Teams are expected to understand both the letter and spirit of the rules. Tournament administrators may issue rulings not explicitly covered if required to preserve competitive integrity.

Rulebook Amendments

The organizer reserves the right to amend, update, or clarify any part of this rulebook at any time. All changes will be communicated through official channels and are binding upon publication.

Acceptance of Rules

By registering and participating in the BC Game Masters Championship, all teams and players agree to abide by all rules contained in this document, respect tournament officials and staff, accept that admin decisions are final, and uphold fair play and sportsmanship.

SECTION 14 – GOVERNING LAW & JURISDICTION

Governing Law

This Rulebook and participation in the BC Game Masters Championship shall be governed by and interpreted in accordance with the laws of the Emirate of Dubai and the federal laws of the United Arab Emirates.

Jurisdiction

Any dispute arising in connection with the tournament, including its organization, administration, prize payments, or interpretation of these rules, shall be subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts of Dubai, United Arab Emirates.

Language

The official language of the tournament and this Rulebook is English.